Mini Assessment

API Handling & JSON Safety

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Questions & Answers

1. If an API returns 429, what should your program do?

Answer: HTTP 429 means **Too Many Requests**. The program should wait before retrying. If the response provides a **Retry-After** value, follow it. Use a limited number of retries with backoff instead of repeatedly sending requests immediately.

2. If response.json() fails, what should your program do?

Answer: The server may have returned invalid JSON, HTML, or plain text. The program should catch the JSON parsing error and handle it gracefully instead of crashing. It can check the response status/content type and provide an appropriate fallback or error message.

3. If a JSON key is missing, why might .get() be safer than []?

Answer: Using **data["key"]** raises a **KeyError** when the key is missing. Using **data.get("key")** safely returns **None**, or a default value can be supplied, for example **data.get("name", "Unknown")**.

Quick Revision

Status / Situation	What to do
429 Too Many Requests	Wait, respect Retry-After, then retry with limited backoff.
JSON parsing fails	Catch the parsing error and safely handle invalid/non-JSON responses.
JSON key may be missing	Prefer .get("key") or .get("key", default) when absence is expected.